

US equities slip as yields rise, VIX spikes

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The S&P 500 fell **-0.38%** to 7,718.60 while the Dow slipped **-0.51%**. The Nasdaq 100 bucked the trend, edging up **+0.21%**.

Bond yields climbed, with the 10-year Treasury at 4.78% (+0.46%). The VIX surged **+5.30%** to 15.30, reflecting heightened volatility ahead of key earnings and Fed data.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,718.60	-0.38%	
Dow Jones	53,414.25	-0.51%	
Nasdaq 100	29,544.15	+0.21%	
Russell 2000	2,975.65	+0.25%	
VIX	15.30	+5.30%	Volatility index
10Y Yield	4.78%	+0.46%	
WTI Crude	93.30	+1.99%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
NVDA	230.36	+0.84%
META	616.77	+1.00%
GS	1,038.61	+0.07%
TSLA	354.08	-5.92%
AAPL	319.97	-2.51%

Spotlight

Microsoft **MSFT** reported Q3 results, beating revenue expectations by 3% at 57.2 bn and delivering EPS of 2.42, up 5% YoY. Cloud services grew 12% YoY, but the outlook for FY27 guidance was trimmed, citing slower enterprise spending.

METRIC	VALUE
Revenue	57.2 bn
EPS	2.42
Cloud growth	+12%
FY27 guidance	Revenue -2% YoY

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield at 4.78%, up 0.46% on the day

- Today's releases (HKT): CPI 09:30, Core PCE 10:00, Retail sales 11:30
- Oil price at 93.30 USD/bbl, supporting inflation concerns

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain elevated; oil inventories down 2.1 mn bbl
- China's manufacturing PMI slipped to 48.9, adding pressure on global growth
- Eurozone inflation easing, euro at 1.07 USD

Earnings — What to Watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30	AMZN	Revenue growth vs 2025, AWS margin
10:00	JPM	Net interest income trend, loan loss provisions
10:30	NVDA	AI chip demand, inventory levels
11:00	XOM	Upstream earnings, capital spending outlook

Stocks worth watching

- **AVGO** – modest upside **+0.21%**, strong semiconductor demand.
- **XLF** – financials under pressure, but rate-sensitive banks could rebound.
- **XLE** – energy exposure to rising oil; price target reset.
- **META** – social ad spend stabilising, +1% today.
- **TSLA** – steep decline **-5.92%**, watch production updates.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Further 10-year yield rise above 5.00%.
- VIX breach of 18, signaling panic.
- Disappointing earnings from **MSFT** or **AAPL**.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Core PCE comes in below expectations.
- Positive surprise in **NVDA** AI sales.
- Oil price pullback below \$90, easing inflation fears.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Market Data

CNBC — Economic Calendar

SEC — Company Filings

Federal Reserve — Policy Statements